

Head & Neck Muscles

MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Auricularis anterior	Temporal fascia, epicranial aponeurosis	Anterior part of medial surface of helix of ear	Posterior auricular and temporal branches of facial nerve	Elevates and draws ear forward	Auricular branch of posterior auricular artery, parietal branch of superficial temporal artery	External ear
Auricularis posterior	Base of mastoid process	Lower part of cranial surface of auricle	Posterior auricular and temporal branches of facial nerve	Retracts and elevates ear	Auricular branch of posterior auricular artery, parietal branch of superficial temporal artery	External ear
Auricularis superior	Temporal fascia, epicranial aponeurosis	Upper part of medial surface of auricle	Posterior auricular and temporal branches of facial nerve	Retracts and elevates ear	Auricular branch of posterior auricular artery, parietal branch of superficial temporal artery	External ear
Buccinator	Posterior portion of alveolar process of maxilla and mandible opposite sockets of molar teeth, anterior border of pterygomandibular raphe	Angle of mouth	Buccal branches of facial nerve	Compresses cheeks, expels air between lips, aids in mastication	Muscular branches of facial artery, buccal branch of maxillary artery	Facial expression
Ciliary	Corneoscleral junction	Ciliary body	Parasympathetic fibers via short ciliary nerves (CN III)	Constricts ciliary body and lens rounds up (accommodation)	Ophthalmic artery	Intrinsic eye
Corrugator supercilii	Medial part of supra-orbital margin	Skin of medial half of eyebrow	Zygomatic and temporal branches of facial nerve	Draws eyebrows downward and medially, produces wrinkles in frowning	Zygomatic and anterior branches of superficial temporal artery	Facial expression
Cricothyroid	Anterior cricoid cartilage	Inferior border of thyroid cartilage and its inferior horn	External branch of superior laryngeal nerve	Lengthens and tenses vocal ligaments	Superior and inferior thyroid arteries	Laryngeal
Depressor anguli oris	Continuous with platysma on oblique line of mandible	Angle of mouth into orbicularis and skin	Mandibular and buccal branches of facial nerve	Depresses angle of mouth	Inferior labial branch of facial artery	Facial expression
Depressor labii inferioris	Lateral surface of mandible between symphysis and mental foramen deep to depressor anguli oris	Skin to lower lip, mingling with orbicularis oris, medial fibers joining those of opposite side	Mandibular and buccal branches of facial nerve	Depresses lower lip and draws it lateralward	Inferior labial branch of facial artery	Facial expression
Depressor septi nasi	Incisive fossa of maxilla	Septum and posterior part of ala of nose	Zygomatic and buccal branches of facial nerve	Narrows nostril, draws septum downward	Superior labial branch of facial artery	Facial expression
Digastric	<i>Anterior belly:</i> digastric fossa of mandible <i>Posterior belly:</i> mastoid notch of temporal bone	Intermediate tendon attached to body of hyoid	<i>Anterior belly:</i> nerve to mylohyoid <i>Posterior belly:</i> facial nerve	Raises hyoid bone and base of tongue, steadies hyoid bone, opens mouth by lowering mandible	<i>Anterior belly:</i> branches of submental artery <i>Posterior belly:</i> muscular branches of posterior auricular artery, muscular branches of occipital artery	Suprahyoid
Dilator pupillae	Radial fibers in iris	Blends with sphincter pupillae fibers	Sympathetic fibers from SCG	Dilates pupil	Ophthalmic artery	Intrinsic eye
Frontal belly of occipitofrontalis	Epicranial aponeurosis at level of coronal suture	Skin of frontal region, epicranial aponeurosis	Temporal branches of facial nerve	Wrinkles forehead skin, raises eyebrows	Frontal branch of superficial temporal artery	Facial expression

Variations in spinal nerve contributions to the innervation of muscles, their arterial supply, their attachments, and their actions are common themes in human anatomy. Therefore, expect differences between texts and realize that anatomical variation is normal.

MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Genioglossus	Mental spine of mandible	Dorsum of tongue, hyoid bone	Hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)	Depresses and protrudes tongue	Sublingual and submental arteries	Extrinsic tongue
Geniohyoid	Inferior genial tubercle on back of symphysis of mandible	Anterior surface of body of hyoid bone	Branch of C1 through hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)	Elevates hyoid bone and depresses mandible	Sublingual branch of lingual artery	Suprahyoid
Hyoglossus	Body and greater horn of hyoid bone	Lateral and inferior aspect of tongue	Hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)	Depresses and retracts tongue	Sublingual and submental arteries	Extrinsic tongue
Inferior longitudinal muscle of tongue	Under surface of tongue between genioglossus and hyoglossus	Tip of tongue blending with styloglossus	Hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)	Shortens tongue, turns tip and sides downward	Deep lingual branch of lingual artery, branches from facial artery	Intrinsic tongue
Inferior oblique	Anterior floor of orbit lateral to nasolacrimal canal	Lateral sclera deep to lateral rectus	Oculomotor nerve (CN III), inferior division	Abducts, elevates, and laterally rotates eyeball	Ophthalmic artery	Extra-ocular
Inferior pharyngeal constrictor	Oblique line of thyroid cartilage and cricoid cartilage	Median raphe of pharynx	Vagus nerve via pharyngeal plexus	Constricts wall of pharynx during swallowing	Ascending pharyngeal artery, branches of superior thyroid artery	Circular pharyngeal
Inferior rectus	Common tendinous ring	Inferior aspect of eyeball, posterior to corneoscleral junction	Oculomotor nerve (CN III), inferior division	Depresses, adducts, and laterally rotates eyeball	Ophthalmic artery	Extra-ocular
Lateral crico-arytenoid	Arch of cricoid cartilage	Muscular process of arytenoid cartilage	Recurrent laryngeal nerve	Adducts vocal folds	Superior and inferior thyroid arteries	Laryngeal
Lateral pterygoid	<i>Superior head:</i> infratemporal surface of greater wing of sphenoid <i>Inferior head:</i> lateral pterygoid plate	Pterygoid fovea, capsule of temporomandibular joint, articular disc	Mandibular nerve (CN V ₃), muscular branches from anterior division	<i>Bilaterally:</i> protrude mandible <i>Unilaterally and alternately:</i> produces side-to-side grinding	Muscular branches of maxillary artery	Mastication
Lateral rectus	Common tendinous ring	Lateral aspect of eyeball, posterior to corneoscleral junction	Abducent nerve (CN VI)	Abducts eyeball	Ophthalmic artery	Extra-ocular
Levator anguli oris	Canine fossa of maxilla immediately below infra-orbital foramen and under cover of zygomatic head of levator labii superioris	Angle of mouth; fibers intermingle with orbicularis oris, depressor anguli oris, zygomaticus	Zygomatic and buccal branches of facial nerve	Elevates angle of mouth	Superior labial branch of facial artery	Facial expression
Levator labii superioris alaeque nasi	<i>Angular head:</i> upper part of frontal process of maxilla <i>Infra-orbital head:</i> orbit above infra-orbital foramen <i>Zygomatic head:</i> malar surface of zygomatic bone	<i>Angular head:</i> into greater alar cartilage, skin of nose, lateral upper lip <i>Infra-orbital head:</i> into muscular substance of upper lip between angular head and caninus <i>Zygomatic head:</i> into skin of nasolabial groove and upper lip	Zygomatic and buccal branches of facial nerve	<i>Angular head:</i> elevates upper lip and dilates nostril <i>Infra-orbital head:</i> raises angle of mouth <i>Zygomatic head:</i> elevates upper lip laterally	Superior labial branch and angular branches of facial artery	Facial expression

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Levator labii superioris	Maxilla above infra-orbital foramen	Skin of upper lip	Zygomatic and buccal branches of facial nerve	Elevates upper lip, dilates nares	Superior labial artery and angular branches of facial artery	Facial expression
Levator palpebrae superioris	Lesser wing of sphenoid, anterior to optic canal	Superior tarsal plate	Oculomotor nerve (CN III), superior division	Raises upper eyelid	Ophthalmic artery	Extra-ocular; eyelid
Levator veli palatini	Temporal bone (petrous portion)	Palatine aponeurosis	Vagus nerve via pharyngeal plexus	Elevates soft palate during swallowing	Ascending palatine artery branch of facial artery, descending palatine artery branch of maxillary artery	Palatal
Longus capitis	Anterior tubercles of transverse processes of C3–C6	Inferior surface of basilar part of occipital bone	Ventral rami of cervical nerves (C1–C4)	Flexes and assists in rotating cervical vertebrae and head	Ascending cervical branch of inferior thyroid artery, ascending pharyngeal artery, muscular branches of vertebral artery	Prevertebral
Longus colli	<i>Vertical portion:</i> C5–T3 vertebrae <i>Inferior oblique portion:</i> T1–T3 vertebrae <i>Superior oblique portion:</i> anterior tubercles of transverse processes of C3–C5 vertebrae	<i>Vertical portion:</i> into C2–C4 vertebrae <i>Inferior oblique portion</i> on anterior tubercles of transverse processes of C5–C6 vertebrae <i>Superior oblique portion:</i> tubercle of anterior arch of atlas	Ventral primary rami of cervical nerves (C2–C8)	<i>Bilaterally:</i> flex and assist in rotating cervical vertebrae and head <i>Unilaterally:</i> flexes vertebral column laterally	Prevertebral branches of ascending pharyngeal artery, muscular branches of ascending cervical and vertebral arteries	Prevertebral
Masseter	Zygomatic arch	Ramus of mandible, coronoid process	Mandibular nerve (CN V ₃), via masseteric nerve	Elevates and protrudes mandible; deep fibers retrude it	Transverse facial artery; masseteric branch of maxillary and facial arteries	Mastication
Medial pterygoid	Medial surface of lateral plate of pterygoid, pyramidal process of palatine bone, maxillary tuberosity	Medial surface of ramus and angle of mandible inferior to mandibular foramen	Mandibular nerve (V ₃), nerve to medial pterygoid	<i>Bilaterally:</i> protrude and elevate mandible <i>Unilaterally and alternately:</i> produces side-to-side movements	Facial and maxillary arteries	Mastication
Medial rectus	Common tendinous ring	Medial aspect of eyeball, posterior to corneoscleral junction	Oculomotor nerve (CN III), inferior division	Adducts eyeball	Ophthalmic artery	Extra-ocular
Mentalis	Incisive fossa of mandible	Skin of chin	Mandibular branch of facial nerve	Raises and protrudes lower lip	Inferior labial branch of facial artery	Facial expression
Middle pharyngeal constrictor	Stylohyoid ligament and horns of hyoid bone	Median raphe of pharynx	Vagus nerve via pharyngeal plexus	Constricts wall of pharynx during swallowing	Ascending pharyngeal artery, ascending palatine and tonsillar branches of facial artery, dorsal lingual branches of lingual artery	Circular pharyngeal
Mylohyoid	Mylohyoid line of mandible	Median raphe and body of hyoid bone	Nerve to mylohyoid nerve (branch of trigeminal nerve)	Elevates hyoid bone, base of tongue, floor of mouth; depresses mandible	Sublingual branch of lingual artery, submental branch of facial artery	Suprahyoid

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Nasalis	Canine eminence above and lateral to incisive fossa of maxilla	Aponeurosis on nasal cartilages	Zygomatic and buccal branches of facial nerve	Draws ala of nose toward septum, compresses nostrils; alar part opens nostrils	Superior labial, septal, and lateral nasal branches of facial artery	Facial expression
Occipital belly (occipitalis) of epicranium	Lateral 2/3 of superior nuchal line and mastoid process	Skin of occipital region, epicranial aponeurosis	Posterior auricular branches of facial nerve	Moves scalp backward	Occipital branch of posterior auricular artery, descending branch of occipital artery	Facial expression
Omohyoid	<i>Inferior belly:</i> from upper border of scapula and suprascapular ligament, ending in tendon under sternocleidomastoid muscle <i>Superior belly:</i> from this tendon	<i>Inferior belly:</i> to intermediate tendon <i>Superior belly:</i> to body of hyoid bone	Ansa cervicalis	Steadies hyoid bone and depresses hyoid	Hyoid branch of lingual artery, sternocleidomastoid branch of superior thyroid artery	Infrahyoid
Orbicularis oculi	Medial orbital margin, palpebral ligament, lacrimal bone	Skin around orbit, palpebral ligament, upper and lower eyelids	Facial nerve (CN VII)	Closes eyelids	Facial and superficial temporal arteries	Facial expression
Orbicularis oris	Maxilla above incisor teeth	Skin around lips	Zygomatic, buccal, and mandibular branches of facial nerve	Compression, contraction, and protrusion of lips	Inferior and superior labial branches of facial artery	Facial expression
Palatoglossus	Palatine aponeurosis of soft palate	Lateral aspect of tongue	Vagus nerve via pharyngeal plexus	Elevates posterior tongue, depresses palate	Ascending pharyngeal arteries, palatine branches of facial and maxillary arteries	Palatal
Palatopharyngeus	Hard palate, superior palatine aponeurosis	Lateral pharyngeal wall	Vagus nerve via pharyngeal plexus	Tenses soft palate; pulls walls of pharynx superiorly, anteriorly, and medially during swallowing	Ascending palatine artery branch of facial artery, descending palatine artery branch of maxillary artery	Longitudinal pharyngeal
Platysma	Skin below clavicle, upper thorax	Mandible, oral muscles	Facial nerve	Tenses skin of neck	Submental and suprascapular arteries	Facial expression
Posterior crico-arytenoid	Posterior surface of lamina of cricoid cartilage	Muscular process of arytenoid cartilage	Recurrent laryngeal nerve	Abducts vocal folds	Superior and inferior thyroid arteries	Laryngeal
Procerus	Fascia covering lower parts of nasal bone and upper part of lateral nasal cartilage	Skin between and above eyebrow	Temporal and zygomatic branches of facial nerve	Draws down medial angle of eyebrows, produces transverse wrinkles over bridge of nose	Angular and lateral nasal branches of facial artery	Facial expression
Rectus capitis anterior	Lateral mass of atlas	Base of occipital bone in front of foramen magnum	Ventral rami of cervical nerves (C1–C2)	Flexes head	Muscular branches of vertebral artery, ascending pharyngeal artery	Prevertebral
Rectus capitis lateralis	Upper surface of transverse process of atlas	Inferior surface of jugular process of occipital bone	Ventral rami of cervical nerves (C1–C2)	Flexes head laterally to same side	Muscular branches of vertebral artery, occipital artery, ascending pharyngeal artery	Prevertebral
Risorius	Fascia over masseter superficial to platysma	Skin at angle of mouth	Zygomatic and buccal branches of facial nerve	Retracts angle of mouth	Superior labial branch of facial artery	Facial expression
Salpingopharyngeus	Pharyngotympanic (auditory, eustachian) tube	Side of pharyngeal wall	Vagus nerve via pharyngeal plexus	Elevates pharynx and larynx during swallowing and speaking	Pharyngeal branch of ascending pharyngeal artery	Longitudinal pharyngeal

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Scalene (anterior)	Anterior tubercles of transverse processes of C3–C6	Scalene tubercle on 1st rib	Anterior rami of cervical nerves (C5–C8)	Elevates 1st rib, bends neck	Ascending cervical branch of inferior thyroid artery	Prevertebral
Scalene (medius)	Posterior tubercles of transverse processes of C2–C7	Upper surface of 1st rib (behind subclavian groove)	Anterior rami of cervical nerves (C3–C7)	Elevates 1st rib, bends neck	Muscular branches of ascending cervical artery	Prevertebral
Scalene (posterior)	Posterior tubercles of transverse processes of C4–C6	Outer surface of 2nd rib (behind attachment of serratus anterior)	Anterior rami of lower four cervical nerves	Elevates 2nd rib, bends neck	Muscular branches of ascending cervical division of inferior thyroid artery, superficial branch of transverse cervical artery	Prevertebral
Sphincter pupillae	Circular smooth muscle of iris that passes around pupil	Blends with dilator pupillae fibers	Parasympathetic fibers via oculomotor nerve (CN III)	Constricts pupil	Ophthalmic artery	Intrinsic eye
Stapedius	Pyramidal eminence of temporal bone	Stapes	Facial nerve	Pulls stapes posteriorly to lessen oscillation of tympanic membrane	Posterior auricular, anterior tympanic, and middle meningeal arteries	Middle ear
Sternocleidomastoid	<i>Sternal head:</i> anterior surface of manubrium <i>Clavicular head:</i> upper surface of medial 1/3 of clavicle	Lateral surface of mastoid process; lateral half of superior nuchal line of occipital bone	Accessory nerve (CN XI)	<i>Bilaterally:</i> flex head, raise thorax <i>Unilaterally:</i> turns face toward opposite side	Sternocleidomastoid branch of superior thyroid and occipital arteries, muscular branch of suprascapular artery, occipital branch of posterior auricular artery	Neck
Sternohyoid	Posterior surface of manubrium sterni, posterior sternoclavicular ligament, medial end of clavicle	Medial part of lower border of body of hyoid bone	Ansa cervicalis	Depresses larynx and hyoid bone, steadies hyoid bone	Sternocleidomastoid and hyoid branches of superior thyroid artery, hyoid branch of lingual artery	Infrahyoid
Sternothyroid	Posterior surface of manubrium sterni below and deep to origin of sternoxyoid, edge of first costal cartilage	Oblique line on lamina of thyroid cartilage	Ansa cervicalis	Depresses larynx and thyroid cartilage	Cricothyroid branch of superior thyroid artery	Infrahyoid
Styloglossus	Styloid process and stylohyoid ligament	Lateral and inferior aspect of tongue	Hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)	Retracts tongue and draws it up for swallowing	Sublingual artery	Extrinsic tongue
Stylohyoid	Posterior border of styloid process	Body of hyoid bone at junction with greater horn	Facial nerve	Elevates hyoid bone and base of tongue	Muscular branches of facial artery, muscular branches of occipital artery	Suprahyoid
Stylopharyngeus	Medial aspect of styloid process	Pharyngeal wall	Glossopharyngeal nerve (CN IX)	Elevates pharynx and larynx during swallowing and speaking	Ascending pharyngeal artery, ascending palatine and tonsillar branches of facial artery, dorsal branches of lingual artery	Longitudinal pharyngeal
Subclavius	Upper border of 1st rib and its cartilage	Inferior surface of middle third of clavicle	Nerve to subclavius	Anchors and depresses clavicle	Clavicular branch of thoraco-acromial artery	Neck
Superior longitudinal muscle of tongue	Submucous fibers at back of tongue	Tip of tongue; unites with muscle of opposite side	Hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)	Shortens tongue, turns tip and sides upward	Deep lingual branch of lingual artery, branches from facial artery	Intrinsic tongue
Superior oblique	Body of sphenoid (above optic foramen), medial to origin of superior rectus	Passes through trochlea, attaches to superior sclera between superior and lateral recti	Trochlear nerve (CN IV)	Abducts, depresses, and medially rotates eyeball	Ophthalmic artery	Extra-ocular

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Superior pharyngeal constrictor	Hamulus, pterygomandibular raphe, mylohyoid line of mandible	Median raphe of pharynx	Vagus nerve via pharyngeal plexus	Constricts wall of pharynx during swallowing	Ascending pharyngeal artery, ascending palatine and tonsillar branches of facial artery, dorsal branches of lingual artery	Circular pharyngeal
Superior rectus	Common tendinous ring	Superior aspect of eyeball, posterior to the corneoscleral junction	Oculomotor nerve (CN III), superior division	Elevates, adducts, and medially rotates eyeball	Ophthalmic artery	Extra-ocular
Temporalis	Floor of temporal fossa, deep temporal fascia	Coronoid process and ramus of mandible	Mandibular nerve (CN V ₃), deep temporal nerves	Elevates mandible; posterior fibers retrude mandible	Superficial temporal and maxillary arteries, middle, anterior, and posterior deep temporal arteries	Mastication
Tensor tympani	Cartilage of pharyngotympanic (auditory, eustachian) tube	Handle of malleus	Mandibular branch of trigeminal nerve (CN V ₃)	Tenses tympanic membrane by drawing it medially	Superior tympanic branch of middle meningeal division of maxillary artery	Middle ear
Tensor veli palatini	Scaphoid fossa of medial pterygoid plate, spine of sphenoid, pharyngotympanic (auditory, eustachian) tube	Palatine aponeurosis	Mandibular nerve	Tenses soft palate, opens pharyngotympanic (auditory, eustachian) tube during swallowing and yawning	Ascending palatine artery branch of facial artery, descending palatine artery branch of maxillary artery	Palatal
Thyro-arytenoid	Posterior aspect of thyroid cartilage	Muscular process of arytenoid cartilage	Recurrent laryngeal nerve	Shortens and relaxes vocal cords, sphincter of vestibule	Superior and inferior thyroid arteries	Laryngeal
Thyrohyoid	Oblique line on lamina of thyroid cartilage	Lower border of body and greater horn of hyoid bone	Thyrohyoid branch of C1 nerve via hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)	Depresses larynx and hyoid bone, elevates thyroid cartilage	Hyoid branch of superior thyroid artery	Infrahyoid
Transverse and oblique arytenoid	Arytenoid cartilage	Opposite arytenoid cartilage	Recurrent laryngeal nerve	Closes intercartilaginous portion of rima glottides	Superior and inferior thyroid arteries	Laryngeal
Transverse (tongue)	Median fibrous septum of tongue	Dorsum and sides of tongue	Hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)	Narrows and elongates tongue	Deep lingual branch of lingual artery, branches from facial artery	Intrinsic tongue
Uvular muscle	Nasal spine, palatine aponeurosis	Mucosa of uvula	Vagus nerve via pharyngeal plexus	Shortens, elevates, and retracts uvula	Ascending palatine artery branch of facial artery, descending palatine artery branch of maxillary artery	Palatal
Vertical (tongue)	Mucous membrane on dorsum of forepart of tongue	Fibers extend from dorsum to undersurface of tongue	Hypoglossal nerve (CN XII)	Flattens and broadens tongue	Deep lingual branch of lingual artery, branches from facial artery	Intrinsic tongue
Vocalis	Vocal process of arytenoid cartilage	Vocal ligament	Recurrent laryngeal nerve	Tenses anterior vocal ligament, relaxes posterior vocal ligament	Superior and inferior thyroid arteries	Laryngeal
Zygomaticus major	Zygomatic arch	Angle of mouth	Zygomatic and buccal branches of facial nerve	Draws angle of mouth backward and upward	Superior labial branch of facial artery	Facial expression
Zygomaticus minor	Zygomatic arch	Angle of mouth, upper lip	Zygomatic and buccal branches of facial nerve	Elevates upper lip	Superior labial branch of facial artery	Facial expression

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Erector spinae	Posterior sacrum, iliac crest, sacrospinous ligament, supraspinous ligament, spinous processes of lower lumbar and sacral vertebrae	<i>Iliocostalis</i> : angles of lower ribs, cervical transverse processes <i>Longissimus</i> : between tubercles and angles of ribs, transverse processes of thoracic and cervical vertebrae, mastoid process <i>Spinalis</i> : spinous processes of upper thoracic and midcervical vertebrae	Dorsal rami of each region	Extends and laterally bends vertebral column and head	<i>Cervical portions</i> : occipital, deep cervical, and vertebral arteries <i>Thoracic portions</i> : dorsal branches of posterior intercostal, subcostal, and lumbar arteries <i>Sacral portions</i> : dorsal branches of lateral sacral arteries	Sacrospinalis
Interspinales (cervical, thoracic, lumbar)	Spinous process	Adjacent spinous process	Dorsal rami of spinal nerves	Aid in extension of vertebral column	<i>Cervical portions</i> : occipital, deep cervical, and vertebral arteries <i>Thoracic portions</i> : dorsal branches of posterior intercostal arteries <i>Lumbar portions</i> : dorsal branches of lumbar arteries	Segmental
Intertransversarii (cervical, thoracic, lumbar)	Extend between adjacent transverse processes of vertebrae	Extend between adjacent transverse processes of vertebrae	Dorsal rami of spinal nerves	Assist in lateral flexion of vertebral column	<i>Cervical portions</i> : occipital, deep cervical, and vertebral arteries <i>Thoracic portions</i> : dorsal branches of posterior intercostal, subcostal, and lumbar arteries <i>Lumbar portions</i> : dorsal branches of lateral lumbar arteries	Segmental
Latissimus dorsi	Spinous processes of T7–L5, thoracolumbar fascia, iliac crest, and last three ribs	Humerus (intertubercular sulcus)	Thoracodorsal nerve	Extends, adducts, and medially rotates humerus	Thoracodorsal artery, dorsal perforating branches of 9th, 10th, and 11th posterior intercostal, subcostal, and first three lumbar arteries	Superficial back
Levator scapulae	Posterior tubercles of transverse processes of C1–C4	Medial border of scapula from superior angle to spine	Ventral rami of C3–C4 and dorsal scapular nerve	Elevates scapula medially, inferiorly rotates glenoid cavity	Dorsal scapular artery, transverse cervical artery, ascending cervical artery	Superficial back
Multifidus	Sacrum, ilium, transverse processes of T1–T12, and articular processes of C4–C7	Spinous processes of vertebrae above, spanning two to four segments	Dorsal rami of each region	Stabilizes spine	<i>Cervical portions</i> : occipital, deep cervical, and vertebral arteries <i>Thoracic portions</i> : dorsal branches of posterior intercostal, subcostal, and lumbar arteries <i>Sacral portions</i> : dorsal branches of lateral sacral arteries	Transversospinalis
Obliquus capitis inferior	Spine of axis	Transverse process of atlas	Suboccipital nerve	Rotates atlas to turn face to same side	Vertebral artery, descending branch of occipital artery	Suboccipital
Obliquus capitis superior	Transverse process of atlas	Occipital bone	Suboccipital nerve	Extends and bends head laterally	Vertebral artery, descending branch of occipital artery	Suboccipital
Rectus capitis posterior major	Spine of axis	Inferior nuchal line	Suboccipital nerve	Extends and rotates head to same side	Vertebral artery, descending branch of occipital artery	Suboccipital

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Rectus capitis posterior minor	Tubercle of posterior arch of atlas	Median inferior nuchal line	Suboccipital nerve	Extends head	Vertebral artery, descending branch of occipital artery	Suboccipital
Rhomboid major	Spinous processes of T2–T5 vertebrae	Medial border of scapula below base of spine of scapula	Dorsal scapular nerve	Fixes scapula to thoracic wall and retracts and rotates it to depress glenoid cavity	Dorsal scapular artery OR deep branch of transverse cervical artery, dorsal perforating branches of the upper five or six posterior intercostal arteries	Superficial back
Rhomboid minor	Ligamentum nuchae, spines of C7 and T1 vertebrae	Medial border of scapula at spine of scapula	Dorsal scapular nerve	Fixes scapula to thoracic wall and retracts and rotates it to depress glenoid cavity	Dorsal scapular artery OR deep branch of transverse cervical artery, dorsal perforating branches of the upper five or six posterior intercostal arteries	Superficial back
Rotatores	Transverse processes of cervical, thoracic, and lumbar regions	Lamina and transverse process of spine above, spanning one or two segments	Dorsal rami of spinal nerves	Stabilizes, extends, and rotates spine	Dorsal branches of segmental arteries	Transversospinalis
Semispinalis	Transverse processes of C4–T12	Spinous processes of cervical and thoracic regions	Dorsal rami of spinal nerves	Extends head, neck, and thorax and rotates them to opposite side	<i>Cervical portions:</i> occipital, deep cervical, and vertebral arteries <i>Thoracic portions:</i> dorsal branches of posterior intercostal arteries	Transversospinalis
Serratus posterior inferior	Spinous processes of T11–L2	Inferior aspect of ribs 9–12	Ventral rami of lower thoracic nerves	Depresses ribs	Posterior intercostal arteries	Intermediate back
Serratus posterior superior	Ligamentum nuchae, spinous processes of C7–T3	Superior aspect of ribs 2–4	Ventral rami of upper thoracic nerves	Elevates ribs	Posterior intercostal arteries	Intermediate back
Splenius capitis	Nuchal ligament, spinous process of C7–T3	Mastoid process of temporal bone, lateral third of superior nuchal line	Dorsal rami of middle cervical nerves	<i>Bilaterally:</i> extend head <i>Unilaterally:</i> laterally bends (flexes) and rotates face to same side	Descending branch of occipital artery, deep cervical artery	Spinotransverse
Splenius cervicis	Spinous process of T3–T6	Transverse processes (C1–C3)	Dorsal rami of lower cervical nerves	<i>Bilaterally:</i> extend neck <i>Unilaterally:</i> laterally bends (flexes) and rotates neck toward same side	Descending branch of occipital artery, deep cervical artery	Spinotransverse
Trapezius	Superior nuchal line, external occipital protuberance, nuchal ligament, spinous processes of C7–T12	Lateral third of clavicle, acromion, spine of scapula	Accessory nerve (CN XI)	Elevates, retracts, and rotates scapula; lower fibers depress scapula	Transverse cervical artery, dorsal perforating branches of posterior intercostal arteries	Superficial back

MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Diaphragm	Xiphoid process, lower six costal cartilages, L1–L3 vertebrae	Converge into central tendon	Phrenic nerve	Draws central tendon down and forward during inspiration	Pericardiophrenic, musculophrenic, superior and inferior phrenic arteries	Posterior abdominal wall
External intercostal	Lower border of ribs	Upper border of rib below rib of origin	Intercostal nerves	Supports intercostal spaces in inspiration and expiration, elevates ribs in inspiration	Posterior intercostal arteries, collateral branches of posterior intercostal arteries, costocervical trunk, anterior intercostal branches of internal thoracic artery, musculophrenic artery	Thoracic wall
Innermost intercostal	Lower border of ribs	Upper border of rib below rib of origin	Intercostal nerves	Elevates ribs	Muscular branches of anterior intercostal arteries, muscular branches of posterior intercostal arteries, intercostal branches of internal thoracic and musculophrenic arteries, costocervical trunk branches	Thoracic wall
Internal intercostal	Lower border of ribs	Costal cartilage and edge of costal groove of rib above rib of origin	Intercostal nerves	Prevents pushing out or drawing in of intercostal spaces in inspiration and expiration, lowers ribs in forced expiration	Muscular branches of anterior intercostal arteries, muscular branches of posterior intercostal arteries, intercostal branches of internal thoracic and musculophrenic arteries, costocervical trunk branches	Thoracic wall
Levator costarum	Transverse processes of C7 and T1–T11	Subjacent ribs between tubercle and angle	Dorsal ramus of lower thoracic nerves	Elevates ribs	Posterior intercostal arteries	Thoracic wall
Pectoralis major	Sternal half of clavicle, sternum to 7th rib, cartilages of true ribs, aponeurosis of external oblique muscle	Lateral lip of intertubercular sulcus of humerus	Medial and lateral pectoral nerves	Flexes and adducts arm, rotates arm medially	Pectoral branch of thoraco-acromial artery, perforating branches of internal thoracic artery	Pectoral/axilla region
Pectoralis minor	Outer surface of upper margin of ribs 3–5	Coracoid process of scapula	Medial pectoral nerve	Lowers lateral angle of scapula and protracts scapula	Pectoral branch of thoraco-acromial and intercostal lateral thoracic arteries	Pectoral/axilla region
Serratus anterior	Lateral surfaces of upper 8–9 ribs	Costal surface of medial border of scapula	Long thoracic nerve	Protracts scapula and holds it against thoracic wall	Lateral thoracic artery	Pectoral/axilla region
Serratus posterior inferior	Spinous processes of T11–L2	Inferior aspect of ribs 9–12	Ventral rami of lower thoracic nerves	Depresses ribs	Posterior intercostal arteries	Superficial back
Serratus posterior superior	Ligamentum nuchae, spinous processes of C7–T3	Superior aspect of ribs 2–4	Ventral rami of upper thoracic nerves	Elevates ribs	Posterior intercostal arteries	Superficial back
Subcostal	Internal surface of lower ribs near their angles	Superior borders of 2nd or 3rd rib below	Intercostal nerves	Depresses ribs	Posterior intercostal artery, musculophrenic artery	Thoracic wall
Transversus thoracis	Internal surface of costal cartilages 2–6	Posterior surface of lower sternum	Intercostal nerves	Depresses ribs and costal cartilages	Anterior intercostal arteries, internal thoracic artery	Thoracic wall

Variations in spinal nerve contributions to the innervation of muscles, their arterial supply, their attachments, and their actions are common themes in human anatomy. Therefore, expect differences between texts and realize that anatomical variation is normal.

MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Diaphragm	Xiphoid process, lower six costal cartilages, L1–L3 vertebrae	Converges into central tendon	Phrenic nerve	Draws central tendon down and forward during inspiration	Pericardiophrenic, musculophrenic, superior and inferior phrenic arteries	Posterior abdominal wall
External oblique	External surfaces of ribs 5–12	Linea alba, pubic tubercle, anterior half of iliac crest	Ventral rami of six inferior thoracic nerves	Compresses and supports abdominal viscera, flexes and rotates trunk	Superior and inferior epigastric arteries	Abdominal wall
Iliacus	Superior 2/3 iliac fossa, ala of sacrum, anterior sacro-iliac ligaments	Lesser trochanter of femur and shaft inferior to it, and to psoas major tendon	Femoral nerve	Flexes hip and stabilizes hip joint; acts with psoas major	Iliac branches of ilio-lumbar artery	Posterior abdominal wall
Internal oblique	Thoracolumbar fascia, anterior 2/3 of iliac crest, lateral half of inguinal ligament	Inferior borders of ribs 10–12, linea alba, pubis via conjoint tendon	Ventral rami of six inferior thoracic and first lumbar nerves	Compresses and supports abdominal viscera, flexes and rotates trunk	Superior and inferior epigastric and deep circumflex iliac arteries	Abdominal wall
Psoas major	Transverse processes of lumbar vertebrae, sides of bodies of T12–L5 vertebrae, intervening intervertebral discs	Lesser trochanter of femur	Ventral rami of first four lumbar nerves	Acting superiorly with iliacus, flexes hip; acting inferiorly, flexes vertebral column laterally; used to balance trunk in sitting position; acting inferiorly with iliacus, flexes trunk	Lumbar branches of ilio-lumbar artery	Posterior abdominal wall
Psoas minor	Vertebral margins of T12–L1 vertebrae, corresponding intervertebral disc	Pectineal line, iliopectineal eminence	Ventral rami of first lumbar nerve	Flexes pelvis on vertebral column	Lumbar branch of ilio-lumbar artery	Posterior abdominal wall
Pyramidalis	Body of pubis, anterior to rectus abdominis	Linea alba	Iliohypogastric nerve	Tenses linea alba	Inferior epigastric artery	Abdominal wall
Quadratus lumborum	Medial half of inferior border of 12th rib, tips of lumbar transverse processes	Iliolumbar ligament, internal lip of iliac crest	Ventral rami of T12 and first four lumbar nerves	Extends and laterally flexes vertebral column, fixes 12th rib during inspiration	Iliolumbar artery	Posterior abdominal wall
Rectus abdominis	Pubic symphysis, pubic crest	Xiphoid process, costal cartilages 5–7	Ventral rami of six inferior thoracic nerves	Flexes trunk, compresses abdominal viscera	Superior and inferior epigastric arteries	Abdominal wall
Transversus abdominis	Internal surfaces of costal cartilages 7–12, thoracolumbar fascia, iliac crest, lateral third of inguinal ligament	Linea alba with aponeurosis of internal oblique, pubic crest, and pecten pubis via conjoint tendon	Ventral rami of six inferior thoracic and first lumbar nerves	Compresses and supports abdominal viscera	Deep circumflex iliac and inferior epigastric arteries	Abdominal wall

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Pelvis & Perineum Muscles

MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Bulbospongiosus	<i>Male:</i> median raphe, bulb of penis, perineal body <i>Female:</i> perineal body	<i>Male:</i> perineal membrane, corpus cavernosum, bulb of penis <i>Female:</i> dorsum of clitoris, inferior fascia of urogenital diaphragm, bulb of vestibule, pubic arch	Deep branch of perineal nerve from pudendal nerve	<i>Male:</i> compresses bulb of penis, forces blood into body of penis during erection, removes urine from urethra and semen during ejaculation <i>Female:</i> constricts vaginal orifice, assists in expressing secretions of greater vestibular gland, forces blood into body of clitoris	Internal pudendal artery and its branch (perineal artery)	Perineal
Coccygeus (ischiococcygeus)	Ischial spine, sacrospinous ligament	Inferior sacrum, coccyx	Ventral rami of lower sacral nerves	Supports pelvic viscera, draws coccyx forward	Inferior gluteal artery	Pelvic floor
Compressor urethrae (female only)	Ischiopubic ramus	Anterior aspect of urethra	Perineal branches of pudendal nerve	Sphincter of urethra	Perineal branch of internal pudendal artery	Perineal
Cremaster	Lower edge of internal oblique and middle of inguinal ligament	Pubic tubercle, crest of pubis	Genital branch of genitofemoral nerve	Retracts testicle	Cremasteric branch of inferior epigastric artery	Spermatic cord
Deep transverse perineal	Inner surface of inferior ischial rami	<i>Male:</i> medial tendinous raphe and perineal body <i>Female:</i> sides of vagina	Perineal branches of pudendal nerve	Stabilizes perineal body, supports prostate/vagina	Perineal branch of internal pudendal artery	Perineal
External anal sphincter	Tip of coccyx, anococcygeal ligament	Deeper fibers surround anal canal, attach posteriorly to coccyx and anteriorly to central point of perineum	Perineal and inferior rectal branches of pudendal nerve	Closes anal orifice	Inferior rectal and transverse perineal artery	Perineal
Iliacus	Superior 2/3 of iliac fossa, ala of sacrum, anterior sacro-iliac ligaments	Lesser trochanter of femur and shaft inferior to it, to psoas major tendon	Femoral nerve	Flexes thigh at hips and stabilizes hip joint, acts with psoas major	Iliac branches of ilio-lumbar artery	Anterior thigh
Ischiocavernosus	Inferior internal surface of ischiopubic ramus, ischial tuberosity	Crus of penis or clitoris	Deep branch of perineal nerve from pudendal nerve	Forces blood into body of penis and clitoris during erection	Internal pudendal artery and its branch (perineal artery)	Perineal
Levator ani	Body of pubis, tendinous arch of obturator fascia, ischial spine	Perineal body, coccyx, anococcygeal raphe, walls of prostate or vagina, rectum, anal canal	Ventral rami of lower sacral nerves, perineal nerve	Supports pelvic viscera, raises pelvic floor	Inferior gluteal artery, internal pudendal artery and its branches (inferior rectal and perineal arteries)	Pelvic floor
Obturator internus	Pelvic surface of obturator membrane and surrounding bone	Medial surface of greater trochanter of femur	Nerve to obturator internus	Laterally rotates extended thigh, abducts flexed thigh at hip	Internal pudendal and obturator arteries	Gluteal region

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MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Piriformis	Anterior surface of sacral segments 2–4, sacrotuberous ligament	Superior border of greater trochanter of femur	Ventral rami of L5, S1, S2	Laterally rotates extended thigh, abducts flexed thigh at hip	Superior and inferior gluteal arteries, internal pudendal artery	Gluteal region
Puborectalis	Lower part of pubic symphysis, superior fascia of urogenital diaphragm	Loops around rectum; no distal attachment	Nerve to levator ani muscle			Pelvic floor
Sphincter urethrae	External fibers from junction of inferior pubic and ischial rami and adjacent fascia; internal fibers pass medially to surround membranous urethra	<i>Male:</i> median raphe in front and behind urethra <i>Female:</i> encloses urethra, attaches to sides of vagina	Perineal branches of pudendal nerve	Compresses urethra at end of micturition; in female also compresses the distal vagina	Perineal branch of internal pudendal artery	Perineal
Sphincter urethrovaginalis (female only)	Perineal body	Passes forward and anterior around urethra	Perineal branches of pudendal nerve	Sphincter of urethra and vagina	Perineal branch of pudendal artery	Perineal
Superficial transverse perineal	Ischial rami and tuberosities	Central tendon (perineal body)	Perineal branches of pudendal nerve	Stabilizes central tendon	Perineal branch of internal pudendal artery	Perineal

MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Abductor digiti minimi	Pisiform bone and tendon of flexor carpi ulnaris	Medial side of base of proximal phalanx of little finger (5th digit)	Ulnar nerve (deep branch)	Abducts little finger	Deep palmar branch of ulnar artery	Hand
Abductor pollicis brevis	Flexor retinaculum, tubercles of scaphoid and trapezium	Lateral side of base of proximal phalanx of thumb	Median nerve (recurrent branch)	Abducts thumb	Superficial palmar branch of radial artery	Hand
Abductor pollicis longus	Posterior surface of ulna, radius, and interosseous membrane	Base of 1st metacarpal	Radial nerve (posterior interosseous)	Abducts and extends thumb at carpometacarpal joint	Posterior interosseous artery	Posterior forearm
Adductor pollicis	<i>Oblique head:</i> bases of 2nd and 3rd metacarpals and capitate and adjacent bones <i>Transverse head:</i> anterior surface of 3rd metacarpal	Medial side of base of proximal phalanx of thumb	Ulnar nerve (deep branch)	Adducts thumb	Deep palmar arch	Hand
Anconeus	Posterior surface of lateral epicondyle of humerus	Lateral surface of olecranon and posterior proximal ulna	Radial nerve (C5–T1)	Assists triceps in extending elbow, abducts ulna in pronation	Deep brachial artery	Arm
Biceps brachii	<i>Long head:</i> supraglenoid tubercle of scapula <i>Short head:</i> tip of coracoid process of scapula	Radial tuberosity, fascia of forearm via bicipital aponeurosis	Musculocutaneous nerve (C5, C6)	Flexes and supinates forearm at elbow	Muscular branches of brachial artery	Arm
Brachialis	Distal half of anterior surface of humerus	Coronoid process and tuberosity of ulna	Musculocutaneous nerve and radial nerve (C7)	Flexes forearm at elbow	Radial recurrent artery, muscular branches of brachial artery	Arm
Brachioradialis	Proximal 2/3 of lateral supracondylar ridge of humerus	Lateral side of distal end of radius	Radial nerve	Weak flexion of forearm when forearm is midpronated	Radial recurrent artery	Posterior forearm
Coracobrachialis	Tip of coracoid process of scapula	Middle third of medial surface of humerus	Musculocutaneous nerve	Flexes and adducts arm at shoulder	Muscular branches of brachial artery	Arm
Deltoid	Lateral third of anterior clavicle, lateral acromion, inferior edge of spine of scapula	Deltoid tuberosity of humerus	Axillary nerve	<i>Clavicular part:</i> flexes and medially rotates arm <i>Acromial part:</i> abducts arm beyond initial 15 degrees done by supraspinatus <i>Spinal part:</i> extends and laterally rotates arm	Posterior circumflex humeral artery, deltoid branch of thoraco-acromial artery	Shoulder
Dorsal interosseous muscles	Adjacent sides of two metacarpal bones	Base of proximal phalanges, extensor expansion of digits 2–4	Ulnar nerve (deep branch)	Abduct digits from axial line of hand (3rd digit); flex digits at metacarpophalangeal joint and extend interphalangeal joints	Deep palmar arch	Hand
Extensor carpi radialis brevis	Lateral epicondyle of humerus	Dorsal base of 3rd metacarpal and slip to 2nd metacarpal	Radial nerve (deep branch)	Extends and abducts hand at wrist	Radial artery, radial recurrent artery	Posterior forearm
Extensor carpi radialis longus	Distal third of lateral supracondylar ridge of humerus	Dorsal base of 2nd metacarpal and slip to 3rd metacarpal	Radial nerve	Extends and abducts hand at wrist	Radial artery, radial recurrent artery	Posterior forearm

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MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Extensor carpi ulnaris	Lateral epicondyle of humerus and posterior border of ulna	Dorsal base of 5th metacarpal	Radial nerve (posterior interosseous)	Extends and adducts hand at wrist	Posterior interosseous artery	Posterior forearm
Extensor digiti minimi	Lateral epicondyle of humerus	Extensor expansion of 5th digit	Radial nerve (posterior interosseous)	Extends 5th digit	Posterior interosseous artery	Posterior forearm
Extensor digitorum	Lateral epicondyle of humerus	Extensor expansions of medial four digits	Radial nerve (posterior interosseous)	Extends medial four digits, assists in wrist extension	Posterior interosseous artery	Posterior forearm
Extensor indicis	Posterior surface of ulna and interosseous membrane	Extensor expansion of 2nd digit	Radial nerve (posterior interosseous)	Extends 2nd digit and helps extend hand at wrist	Posterior interosseous artery	Posterior forearm
Extensor pollicis brevis	Posterior surface of radius and interosseous membrane	Dorsal base of proximal phalanx of thumb	Radial nerve (posterior interosseous)	Extends proximal phalanx of thumb at carpometacarpal joint	Posterior interosseous artery	Posterior forearm
Extensor pollicis longus	Posterior surface of middle third of ulna, interosseous membrane	Dorsal base of distal phalanx of thumb	Radial nerve (posterior interosseous)	Extends distal phalanx of thumb at interphalangeal and metacarpophalangeal joints	Posterior interosseous artery	Posterior forearm
Flexor carpi radialis	Medial epicondyle of humerus	Base of 2nd metacarpal	Median nerve	Flexes and abducts hand at wrist	Radial artery	Anterior forearm
Flexor carpi ulnaris	<i>Humeral head:</i> medial epicondyle of humerus <i>Ulnar head:</i> olecranon and posterior border of ulna	Pisiform bone, hook of hamate, base of 5th metacarpal	Ulnar nerve	Flexes and adducts hand at wrist	Posterior ulnar recurrent artery	Anterior forearm
Flexor digiti minimi brevis	Flexor retinaculum and hook of hamate bone	Medial side of base of proximal phalanx of little finger	Ulnar nerve (deep branch)	Flexes proximal phalanx of little finger	Deep palmar branch of ulnar artery	Hand
Flexor digitorum profundus	Medial and anterior surface of proximal 3/4 of ulna and interosseous membrane	Palmar base of distal phalanges of medial four digits	<i>Medial part:</i> ulnar nerve <i>Lateral part:</i> median nerve	Flexes distal phalanges of medial four digits, assists with flexion of hand at wrist	Anterior interosseous artery, muscular branches of ulnar artery	Anterior forearm
Flexor digitorum superficialis	<i>Humero-ulnar head:</i> medial epicondyle of humerus and coronoid process of ulna <i>Radial head:</i> superior half of anterior radius	Bodies of middle phalanges of medial four digits	Median nerve	Flexes middle and proximal phalanges of medial four digits, flexes hand at wrist	Ulnar and radial arteries	Anterior forearm
Flexor pollicis brevis	Flexor retinaculum and tubercle of trapezium	Lateral side of base of proximal phalanx of thumb	Median nerve (recurrent branch)	Flexes proximal phalanx of thumb	Superficial palmar branch of radial artery	Hand
Flexor pollicis longus	Anterior surface of radius and interosseous membrane	Palmar base of distal phalanx of thumb	Median nerve (anterior interosseous)	Flexes phalanges of thumb	Anterior interosseous artery	Anterior forearm
Infraspinatus	Infraspinous fossa of scapula and deep fascia	Middle facet of greater tubercle of humerus	Suprascapular nerve	Lateral rotation of arm (with teres minor)	Suprascapular artery	Shoulder

MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Latissimus dorsi	Spinous processes of T7–L5 vertebrae, thoracolumbar fascia, iliac crest, last 3 ribs	Intertubercular sulcus of humerus	Thoracodorsal nerve	Extends, adducts, and medially rotates humerus at shoulder	Thoracodorsal artery, dorsal perforating branches of 9th, 10th, and 11th posterior intercostal, subcostal, and first three lumbar arteries	Shoulder
Levator scapulae	Posterior tubercles of transverse processes of C1–C4	Medial border of scapula from superior angle to spine	Ventral rami of C3–C4 and dorsal scapular nerve	Elevates scapula medially, inferiorly rotates glenoid cavity	Dorsal scapular artery, transverse cervical artery, ascending cervical artery	Superficial back
Lumbrical, first and second	Lateral two tendons of flexor digitorum profundus	Lateral sides of extensor expansion of digits 2 and 3	Median nerve (digital branches)	Extend digits at interphalangeal joints, flex metacarpophalangeal joints	Superficial and deep palmar arches	Hand
Lumbrical, third and fourth	Medial three tendons of flexor digitorum profundus	Lateral sides of extensor expansion of digits 4 and 5	Ulnar nerve (deep branch)	Extend digits at interphalangeal joints, flex metacarpophalangeal joints	Superficial and deep palmar arches	Hand
Opponens digiti minimi	Flexor retinaculum and hook of hamate bone	Palmar surface of 5th metacarpal	Ulnar nerve (deep branch)	Draws 5th metacarpal anteriorly and rotates it to face thumb	Deep palmar branch of ulnar artery	Hand
Opponens pollicis	Flexor retinaculum and tubercle of trapezium	Lateral side of 1st metacarpal	Median nerve (recurrent branch)	Draws 1st metacarpal forward and rotates it medially	Superficial palmar branch of radial artery	Hand
Palmar interosseous muscles	Sides of metacarpals 2, 4, and 5	Bases of proximal phalanx and extensor expansion of digits 2, 4, and 5	Ulnar nerve (deep branch)	Adducts digits toward axial line of hand (3rd digit); flexes digits at metacarpophalangeal joint and extends interphalangeal joints	Deep palmar arch	Hand
Palmaris brevis	Palmar aponeurosis and flexor retinaculum	Skin of medial border of palm	Superficial palmar branch of ulnar nerve	Deepens hollow of hand, assists grip	Superficial palmar arch	Hand
Palmaris longus	Medial epicondyle of humerus	Distal half of flexor retinaculum and palmar aponeurosis	Median nerve	Flexes hand at wrist and tenses palmar aponeurosis	Posterior ulnar recurrent artery	Anterior forearm
Pectoralis major	Sternal half of clavicle, sternum to 7th rib, cartilages of true ribs, aponeurosis of external oblique muscle	Lateral lip of intertubercular sulcus of humerus	Medial and lateral pectoral nerves	Flexes and adducts arm, rotates arm medially	Pectoral branch of thoraco-acromial artery, perforating branches of internal thoracic artery	Pectoral region/ axilla
Pectoralis minor	Outer surface of upper margin of ribs 3–5	Coracoid process of scapula	Medial pectoral nerve	Lowers lateral angle of scapula and protracts scapula	Pectoral branch of thoraco-acromial and intercostal lateral thoracic arteries	Pectoral region/ axilla
Pronator quadratus	Distal fourth of anterior ulna	Distal fourth of anterior radius	Median nerve (anterior interosseous)	Pronates forearm	Anterior interosseous artery	Anterior forearm
Pronator teres	Two heads: medial epicondyle of humerus and coronoid process of ulna	Midway along lateral surface of radius	Median nerve	Pronates forearm and assists with elbow flexion	Anterior ulnar recurrent artery	Anterior forearm

MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Rhomboid major	Spinous processes of T2–T5 vertebrae	Medial border of scapula below base of spine of scapula	Dorsal scapular nerve	Fixes scapula to thoracic wall and retracts and rotates it to depress glenoid cavity	Dorsal scapular OR deep branch of transverse cervical artery, dorsal perforating branches of the upper five or six posterior intercostal arteries	Superficial back
Rhomboid minor	Ligamentum nuchae, spines of C7 and T1 vertebrae	Medial border of scapula at spine of scapula	Dorsal scapular nerve	Fixes scapula to thoracic wall and retracts and rotates it to depress glenoid cavity	Dorsal scapular artery OR deep branch of transverse cervical artery, dorsal perforating branches of the upper five or six posterior intercostal arteries	Superficial back
Serratus anterior	Lateral surfaces of upper 8–9 ribs	Costal surface of medial border of scapula	Long thoracic nerve	Protracts and rotates scapula and holds it against thoracic wall	Lateral thoracic artery	Shoulder
Subclavius	Upper border of 1st rib and its cartilage	Inferior surface of middle third of clavicle	Nerve to subclavius	Anchors and depresses clavicle	Clavicular branch of thoraco-acromial artery	Shoulder
Subscapularis	Subscapular fossa	Lesser tubercle of humerus	Upper and lower subscapular nerves	Medially rotates arm at shoulder and adducts it, helps hold humeral head in glenoid cavity	Subscapular artery, lateral thoracic artery	Shoulder
Supinator	Lateral epicondyle of humerus, supinator crest of ulna	Lateral, posterior, and anterior surfaces of proximal third of radius	Radial nerve (deep branch)	Supinates forearm	Radial recurrent artery, posterior interosseous arteries	Posterior forearm
Supraspinatus	Supraspinous fossa of scapula and deep fascia	Superior facet of greater tubercle of humerus	Suprascapular nerve	Initiates arm abduction, acts with rotator cuff muscles	Suprascapular artery	Shoulder
Teres major	Posterior surface of inferior angle of scapula	Medial lip of intertubercular sulcus of humerus	Lower subscapular nerve	Adducts and medially rotates arm	Circumflex scapular artery	Shoulder
Teres minor	Upper 2/3 of posterior surface of lateral border of scapula	Inferior facet of greater tubercle of humerus	Axillary nerve	Laterally rotates arm	Circumflex scapular artery	Shoulder
Trapezius	Superior nuchal line, external occipital protuberance, nuchal ligament, spinous processes of C7–T12	Lateral third of clavicle, acromion, and spine of scapula	Accessory nerve (cranial nerve XI)	Elevates, retracts, and rotates scapula; lower fibers depress scapula	Transverse cervical artery, dorsal perforating branches of posterior intercostal arteries	Superficial back
Triceps brachii	<i>Long head:</i> infraglenoid tubercle of scapula <i>Lateral head:</i> upper half of posterior humerus <i>Medial head:</i> distal 2/3 of medial and posterior humerus	Posterior surface of olecranon process of ulna	Radial nerve	Extends forearm at elbow; long head stabilizes head of abducted humerus and extends and adducts arm at shoulder	Branch of profunda brachii artery	Arm

MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Abductor digiti minimi	Medial and lateral tubercles of tuberosity of calcaneus, plantar aponeurosis, and intermuscular septum	Lateral side of base of proximal phalanx of 5th digit	Lateral plantar nerve	Abducts and flexes 5th digit	Medial-lateral plantar artery, plantar metatarsal and plantar digital arteries to 5th digit	Foot
Abductor hallucis	Medial tubercle of tuberosity of calcaneus, flexor retinaculum, and plantar aponeurosis	Medial side of base of proximal phalanx of 1st digit	Medial plantar nerve	Abducts and flexes 1st digit	Medial plantar and 1st plantar metatarsal arteries	Foot
Adductor brevis	Body and inferior pubic ramus	Pectineal line and proximal part of linea aspera of femur	Obturator nerve	Adducts thigh at hip, weak hip flexor	Profunda femoris, medial circumflex femoral, and obturator arteries	Medial thigh
Adductor hallucis	<i>Oblique head:</i> bases of 2nd through 4th metatarsals <i>Transverse head:</i> ligaments of metatarsophalangeal joints of digits 3-5	Tendons of both heads lateral to side of base of proximal phalanx of 1st digit	Deep branch of lateral plantar nerve	Adducts 1st digit, maintains transverse arch of foot	Medial and lateral plantar arteries and plantar arch, plantar metatarsal arteries	Foot
Adductor longus	Body of pubis inferior to pubic crest	Middle third of linea aspera of femur	Obturator nerve (anterior division)	Adducts thigh at hip	Profunda femoris and medial circumflex femoral arteries	Medial thigh
Adductor magnus	Inferior pubic ramus, ramus of ischium <i>Hamstring part:</i> sciatic nerve (tibial division)	Gluteal tuberosity, linea aspera, medial supracondylar line <i>Hamstring part:</i> adductor tubercle of femur	<i>Adductor part:</i> obturator nerve <i>Hamstring part:</i> sciatic nerve (tibial division)	<i>Adductor part:</i> adducts and flexes thigh <i>Hamstring part:</i> extends thigh	Femoral, profunda femoris, and obturator arteries	Medial thigh
Articularis genus	Distal femur on anterior surface	Suprapatellar bursa	Femoral nerve	Pulls suprapatellar bursa superiorly with extension of knee	Femoral artery	Anterior thigh
Biceps femoris	<i>Long head:</i> ischial tuberosity <i>Short head:</i> Linea aspera and lateral supracondylar line of femur	Lateral side of head of fibula	<i>Long head:</i> sciatic nerve (tibial division) (L5-S2) <i>Short head:</i> sciatic nerve (common fibular division)	Flexes and laterally rotates leg, extends thigh at hip	Perforating branches of profunda femoris, inferior gluteal, and medial circumflex femoral arteries	Posterior thigh
Dorsal interossei (four muscles)	Adjacent sides of 1st through 5th metatarsals	<i>1st:</i> medial side of proximal phalanx of 2nd digit <i>2nd through 4th:</i> lateral sides of digits 2-4	Lateral plantar nerve	Abduct 2nd through 4th toes, flex metatarsophalangeal joints, and extend phalanges	Arcuate artery, dorsal and plantar metatarsal arteries	Foot
Extensor digitorum brevis and extensor hallucis brevis	Superolateral surface of calcaneus, lateral talocalcaneal ligament, cruciate crural ligament	First tendon into dorsal surface of base of proximal phalanx of great toe; other 3 tendons into lateral sides of tendons of extensor digitorum longus to digits 2-4	Deep fibular nerve	Aids the extensor digitorum longus in extending of 4 medial digits at the metatarsophalangeal and interphalangeal joints	Dorsalis pedis, lateral tarsal, arcuate, and fibular arteries	Anterior thigh

Variations in spinal nerve contributions to the innervation of muscles, their arterial supply, their attachments, and their actions are common themes in human anatomy. Therefore, expect differences between texts and realize that anatomical variation is normal.

MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Extensor digitorum longus	Lateral condyle of tibia, proximal 3/4 of anterior surface of interosseous membrane and fibula	Middle and distal phalanges of lateral four digits	Deep fibular nerve	Extends lateral four digits and dorsiflexes foot at ankle	Anterior tibial artery	Anterior leg
Extensor hallucis longus	Middle part of anterior surface of fibula and interosseous membrane	Dorsal aspect of base of distal phalanx of great toe	Deep fibular nerve	Extends great toe, dorsiflexes foot at ankle	Anterior tibial artery	Anterior leg
Fibularis peroneus brevis	Distal 2/3 of lateral surface of fibula	Dorsal surface of tuberosity on lateral side of 5th metatarsal	Superficial fibular nerve	Everts foot and weakly plantarflexes foot at ankle	Anterior tibial and fibular arteries	Lateral leg
Fibularis peroneus longus	Head and proximal 2/3 of lateral fibula	Plantar base of 1st metatarsal and medial cuneiform	Superficial fibular nerve	Everts foot and weakly plantarflexes foot at ankle	Anterior tibial and fibular arteries	Lateral leg
Fibularis peroneus tertius	Distal third of anterior surface of fibula and interosseous membrane	Dorsum of base of 5th metatarsal	Deep fibular nerve	Dorsiflexes foot at ankle and aids in eversion of foot	Anterior tibial artery	Anterior leg
Flexor digiti minimi brevis	Base of 5th metatarsal	Lateral base of proximal phalanx of 5th digit	Superficial branch of lateral plantar nerve	Flexes proximal phalanx of 5th digit	Lateral plantar artery, plantar digital artery to 5th digit, arcuate artery	Foot
Flexor digitorum brevis	Medial tubercle of tuberosity of calcaneus, plantar aponeurosis, and intermuscular septum	Both sides of middle phalanges of lateral four digits	Medial plantar nerve	Flexes 2nd through 5th digits	Medial and lateral plantar arteries and plantar arch, plantar metatarsal and plantar digital arteries	Foot
Flexor digitorum longus	Medial part of posterior tibia inferior to soleal line	Plantar bases of distal phalanges of lateral four digits	Tibial nerve	Flexes lateral four digits and plantarflexes foot at ankle; supports longitudinal arches of foot	Posterior tibial artery	Posterior leg
Flexor hallucis brevis	Plantar surfaces of cuboid and lateral cuneiform	Both sides of base of proximal phalanx of 1st digit	Medial plantar nerve	Flexes proximal phalanx of 1st digit	Medial plantar artery, first plantar metatarsal artery	Foot
Flexor hallucis longus	Distal 2/3 of posterior fibula and interosseous membrane	Base of distal phalanx of great toe (hallux)	Tibial nerve	Flexes all joints of great toe, weakly plantarflexes foot at ankle	Fibular artery	Posterior leg
Gastrocnemius	<i>Lateral head:</i> lateral aspect of lateral condyle of femur <i>Medial head:</i> popliteal surface above medial condyle of femur	Posterior aspect of calcaneus via calcaneal tendon	Tibial nerve	Plantarflexes foot at ankle joint, assists in flexion of knee joint, raises heel during walking	Popliteal and posterior tibial arteries	Posterior leg
Gluteus maximus	Ilium posterior to posterior gluteal line, dorsal surface of sacrum and coccyx, sacrotuberous ligament	Most fibers end in iliotibial tract that inserts into lateral condyle of tibia; some fibers insert into gluteal tuberosity of femur	Inferior gluteal nerve	Extends flexed thigh, assists in lateral rotation, and abducts thigh	Inferior gluteal arteries mainly, and superior gluteal arteries occasionally	Gluteal region

MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Gluteus medius	Lateral surface of ilium between anterior and posterior gluteal lines	Lateral surface of greater trochanter of femur	Superior gluteal nerve	Abducts and medially rotates thigh at hips; steadies pelvis on leg when opposite leg is raised	Superior gluteal artery	Gluteal region
Gluteus minimus	Lateral surface of ilium between anterior and inferior gluteal lines	Anterior surface of greater trochanter of femur	Superior gluteal nerve	Abducts and medially rotates thigh at hips; steadies pelvis on leg when opposite leg is raised	Main trunk and deep branch of superior gluteal artery	Gluteal region
Gracilis	Body and inferior ramus of pubis	Superior part of medial surface of tibia	Obturator nerve	Adducts thigh, flexes and medially rotates leg	Profunda femoris artery, medial circumflex femoral artery	Medial thigh
Iliacus (Iliopsoas)	Superior 2/3 of iliac fossa, iliac crest, ala of sacrum, anterior sacro-iliac ligaments	Lesser trochanter of femur and shaft inferior to it, to psoas major tendon	Femoral nerve	Flexes thigh at hips and stabilizes hip joint, acts with psoas major	Iliac branches of iliolumbar artery	Anterior thigh
Inferior gemellus	Ischial tuberosity	Medial surface of greater trochanter of femur	Nerve to quadratus femoris	Laterally rotates extended thigh at the hip	Medial circumflex femoral artery	Gluteal region
Lumbricals	Tendons of flexor digitorum longus	Medial side of dorsal digital expansions of lateral 4 digits	<i>Medial one:</i> medial plantar nerve <i>Lateral three:</i> lateral plantar nerve	Flexes proximal phalanges at MTP joint, extends phalanges at PIP and DIP joints	Lateral plantar artery and plantar metatarsal arteries	Foot
Obturator externus	Margins of obturator foramen, obturator membrane	Trochanteric fossa of femur	Obturator nerve	Laterally rotates thigh, stabilizes head of femur in acetabulum	Medial circumflex femoral artery, obturator artery	Medial thigh
Obturator internus	Pelvic surface of obturator membrane and surrounding bone	Medial surface of greater trochanter of femur	Nerve to obturator internus	Laterally rotates extended thigh, abducts flexed thigh at hip	Internal pudendal and obturator arteries	Gluteal region
Pectineus	Superior ramus of pubis	Pectineal line of femur	Femoral nerve and sometimes obturator nerve	Adducts and flexes thigh at hip	Medial circumflex femoral artery, obturator artery	Medial thigh
Piriformis	Anterior surface of sacral segments 2–4, sacrotuberous ligament	Superior border of greater trochanter of femur	Ventral rami of L5, S1, S2	Laterally rotates extended thigh, abducts flexed thigh at hip	Superior and inferior gluteal arteries, internal pudendal artery	Gluteal region
Plantar interossei (three muscles)	Bases and medial sides of 3rd through 5th metatarsals	Medial sides of bases of proximal phalanges of 3rd through 5th digits	Lateral plantar nerve	Adduct digits (2–4) and flex metatarsophalangeal joint and extend phalanges	Lateral plantar artery and plantar arch, plantar metatarsal and plantar digital arteries	Foot
Plantaris	Inferior end of lateral supracondylar line of femur and oblique popliteal ligament	Posterior aspect of calcaneus via calcaneal tendon	Tibial nerve	Weakly assists gastrocnemius	Popliteal artery	Posterior leg
Popliteus	Lateral aspect of lateral condyle of femur, lateral meniscus	Posterior tibia superior to soleal line	Tibial nerve (L4–S1)	Weakly flexes knee and unlocks it by rotating femur on fixed tibia	Inferior medial and lateral genicular arteries	Posterior leg
Psoas major (Iliopsoas)	Transverse processes of lumbar vertebrae, sides of bodies of T12–L5 vertebrae, intervening intervertebral discs	Lesser trochanter of femur	Ventral rami of first lumbar nerve	Acting superiorly with iliacus, flexes hip; acting inferiorly, flexes vertebral column laterally; used to balance trunk in sitting position; acting inferiorly with iliacus, flexes trunk	Lumbar branches of iliolumbar artery	Anterior thigh
Quadratus femoris	Lateral margin of ischial tuberosity	Quadrate tubercle on intertrochanteric crest of femur	Nerve to quadratus femoris	Laterally rotates thigh at hip	Medial circumflex femoral artery	Gluteal region

MUSCLE	PROXIMAL ATTACHMENT (ORIGIN)	DISTAL ATTACHMENT (INSERTION)	INNERVATION	MAIN ACTIONS	BLOOD SUPPLY	MUSCLE GROUP
Quadratus plantae	Medial and lateral sides of plantar surface of calcaneus	Posterolateral edge of flexor digitorum longus tendon	Lateral plantar nerve	Corrects for oblique pull of flexor digitorum longus tendon, thus assists in flexion of toes	Medial and lateral plantar arteries and deep plantar arterial arch	Foot
Rectus femoris (quadriceps)	Anterior inferior iliac spine and ilium superior to acetabulum	Base of patella and to tibial tuberosity via patellar ligament	Femoral nerve	Extends leg at knee joint and flexes thigh at hip joint	Profunda femoris and lateral circumflex femoral arteries	Anterior thigh
Sartorius	Anterior superior iliac spine and superior part of notch below it	Superior part of medial surface of tibia	Femoral nerve	Abducts, laterally rotates, and flexes thigh; flexes knee joint	Femoral artery	Anterior thigh
Semimembranosus	Ischial tuberosity	Posterior part of medial condyle of tibia	Sciatic nerve (tibial division)	Flexes leg, extends thigh	Perforating branch of profunda femoris and medial circumflex femoral arteries	Posterior thigh
Semitendinosus	Ischial tuberosity	Superior part of medial surface of tibia	Sciatic nerve (tibial division)	Flexes leg, extends thigh	Perforating branch of profunda femoris and medial circumflex femoral arteries	Posterior thigh
Soleus	Posterior aspect of head of fibula, proximal 1/4 of posterior surface of fibula, soleal line of tibia	Posterior aspect of calcaneus via calcaneal tendon	Tibial nerve	Plantarflexes foot at ankle, stabilizes leg over foot	Popliteal, posterior tibial, and fibular arteries	Posterior leg
Superior gemellus	Outer surface of ischial spine	Medial surface of greater trochanter of femur	Nerve to obturator internus	Laterally rotates extended thigh at the hip	Inferior gluteal and internal pudendal arteries	Gluteal region
Tensor fasciae latae	Anterior superior iliac spine and anterior part of iliac crest	Iliotibial tract that attaches to lateral condyle of tibia	Superior gluteal nerve	Abducts, medially rotates, and flexes thigh at hip; helps to keep knee extended	Ascending branch of lateral circumflex femoral artery	Gluteal region
Tibialis anterior	Lateral condyle, proximal half of lateral tibia, interosseous membrane	Medial plantar surfaces of medial cuneiform and base of 1st metatarsal	Deep fibular nerve	Dorsiflexes foot at ankle and inverts foot	Anterior tibial artery	Anterior leg
Tibialis posterior	Posterior tibia below soleal line, interosseous membrane, proximal half of posterior fibula	Tuberosity of navicular bone, all cuneiforms, cuboid, and bases of 2nd through 4th metatarsals	Tibial nerve	Plantarflexes foot at ankle and inverts foot	Fibular artery	Posterior leg
Vastus intermedius (quadriceps)	Anterior and lateral surfaces of body of femur	Base of patella and to tibial tuberosity via patellar ligament	Femoral nerve	Extends leg at knee joint	Lateral circumflex femoral and profunda femoris arteries	Anterior thigh
Vastus lateralis (quadriceps)	Greater trochanter, lateral lip of linea aspera of femur	Base of patella and to tibial tuberosity via patellar ligament	Femoral nerve	Extends leg at knee joint	Lateral circumflex femoral and profunda femoris arteries	Anterior thigh
Vastus medialis (quadriceps)	Intertrochanteric line, medial lip of linea aspera of femur	Base of patella and to tibial tuberosity via patellar ligament	Femoral nerve	Extends leg at knee joint	Femoral and profunda femoris arteries	Anterior thigh